



DOPING DESTROYS FAIR PLAY

THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION AGAINST DOPING IN SPORT (2005)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Sports law

BEFORE

1960 Danish cyclist Knud Jensen dies during the Rome Olympics; he is later found to have taken amphetamines.

1966 Cycling and soccer introduce mandatory drug testing in world championships.

1972 Drug testing is used at the Summer Olympic Games.

1988 Systematic drug abuse is revealed in the Tour de France.

AFTER

2009 The Athlete Biological Passport is introduced; each individual's drug tests are recorded electronically.

2016 The McLaren Report claims that over 1,000 Russian athletes were implicated in state-sponsored doping abuses between 2011 and 2015.

2018 Russia is banned from the Winter Olympics.

The use of performance-enhancing drugs in sports was widespread long before the adoption of the UNESCO anti-doping convention in October 2005. In 1967, the International Olympic Committee (IOC) published a list of prohibited substances, and in 1988, Canadian sprinter Ben Johnson was stripped of his gold medal at the Seoul Olympics after testing positive for anabolic steroids.

The scale of the problem was such that, by the early 21st century, it was deemed necessary to invoke

the legal authority of the United Nations to deal with it. As the UN's Educational, Scientific, and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) considered sports to be "an educational tool," it took on the role. Its convention was ratified in 2007, and signatory nations are bound by international law to its provisions. Much of the practical work falls within the remit of other bodies, including the World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA), established by the IOC in 1999. It cooperates closely with national organizations and is party to the World Anti-Doping Code, first issued in 2004 and regularly updated.

In many cases, the motive for doping in sports (namely, cheating) is a simple matter of an individual's ambition. But the practice also occurs as part of deliberate state-sponsored initiatives. East Germany was the first country to introduce systematic doping, in the 1970s. In 2016–2017, WADA cited Italy, France, and the US as having the most athletes violating the Code, and bodybuilding, athletics, and cycling as having the most violations. ■



Marion Jones (center) won three gold and two bronze medals for the US at the 2000 Olympics. She initially denied accusations of doping but 7 years later admitted to steroid use.

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■ The Match-Fixing Task Force 306–307